

Fermium

100 Fm The element fermium was named after the Italian physicist Enrico Fermi, the creator of the world's first nuclear reactor. Fermium is an artificial element useful only in scientific research.



"Ivy Mike" test

The first successful test of a hydrogen bomb, in the Pacific in 1952, generated tiny amounts of fermium. This bomb was 1,000 times more powerful than nuclear bombs of the time.

Nobelium

102 No American scientists Albert Ghiorso and John R. Walton and Norwegian physicist Torbjørn Sikkeland are credited for the discovery of this element. They created nobelium by making atoms of curium smash into carbon atoms in a cyclotron. It was named after the Swedish chemist and engineer Alfred Nobel. Nobelium has no uses outside of scientific research.



The Nobel Prize medal has Swedish inventor Alfred Nobel's face embossed on it.

Mendelevium

101 Md In 1955, a new element was produced by smashing together atoms of einsteinium and helium in a cyclotron. By atomic number, it is the first element that cannot be produced in visible quantities. It was named after Dmitri Mendeleev, the creator of the modern periodic table. Mendelevium is used only in scientific research.



Russian chemist and inventor Dmitri Mendeleev

Lawrencium

103 Lr Like many other artificially created elements, lawrencium is used only in scientific research. The American nuclear physicist Albert Ghiorso discovered lawrencium at the Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, in California, by firing boron atoms at californium atoms in a cyclotron. This element was named in honor of Ernest Lawrence, inventor of the cyclotron.

American physicist Ernest Lawrence with a cyclotron

